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AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER™



SMOKE AND SHADOW • PART THREE

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SMOKE AND SHADOW • PART THREE

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NO...
NO...

NO!



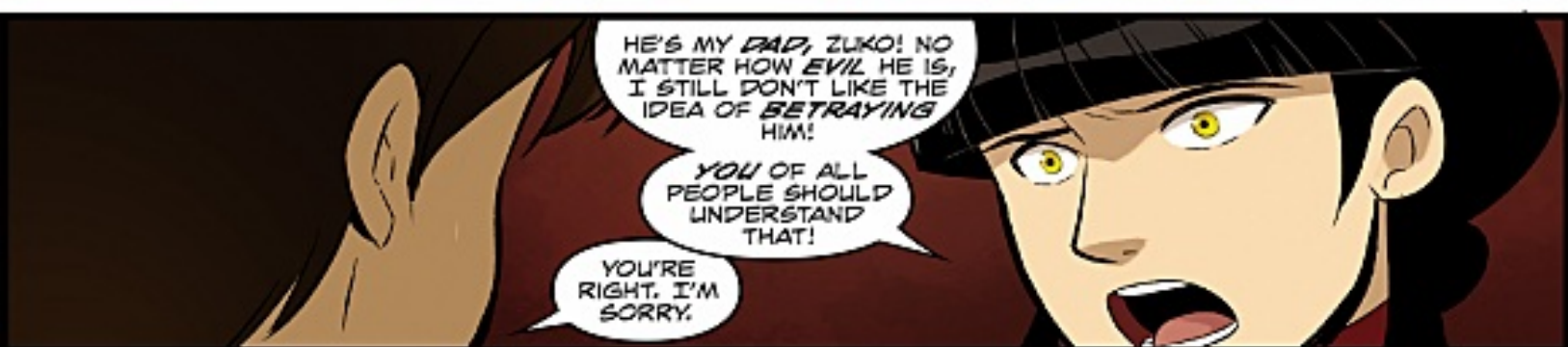
THEY TOOK HER,
DIDN'T THEY? THEY
TOOK MY *BABY*.



I'M
SORRY.







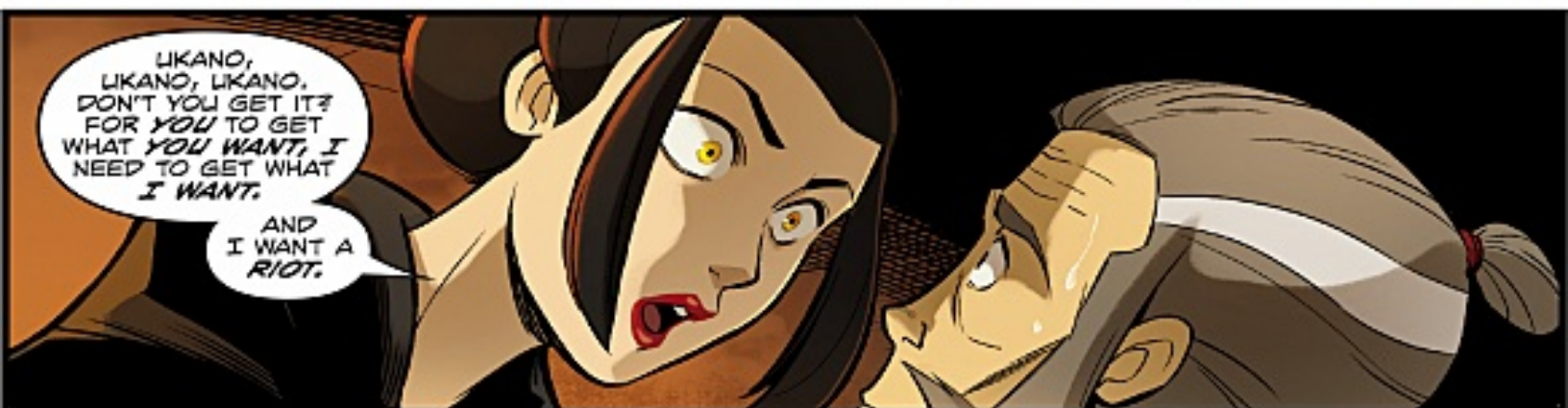














ANYTHING?

NOPE, NOT
A TRACE.



GOTTA
ADMIT, AZULA
AND HER BUDDIES
HAVE THEIR "DARK
SPIRIT" ACT DOWN
COLD.

GUYS,
GUYS! COME
LOOK!



THERE WAS *SOMETHING*
ABOUT THE SPOT WHERE
THE KEMURIKAGE
DISAPPEARED LAST
NIGHT...

...SOMETHING
FUZZY AND HARD
TO REMEMBER...

...BUT
THEN I
FINALLY DID!



WHEN
AZULA, MAI,
AND I USED TO
PLAY HIDE-AND-
GO-SEEK AS KIDS,
AZULA WOULD
DISAPPEAR FOR
HOURS.

MAI AND I
COULD NEVER
FIND HER! IT GOT
REALLY, REALLY
NOT FUN --



--UNTIL
WE FIGURED
OUT HER
SECRET!





UNTIL FURTHER NOTICE, NO ONE IS ALLOWED TO LEAVE THE CAPITAL CITY! FIRE LORD'S ORDERS!

YOU'VE GOTTA BE KIDDING! OUR KIDS ARE SITTING TURTLE-DUCKS FOR THOSE DARK SPIRITS!



FORGIVE THE INTRUSION, CITIZENS, BUT YOUR SAFETY IS OF THE UTMOST IMPORTANCE TO THE FIRE LORD!



WHAT IS THE MEANING OF THIS?

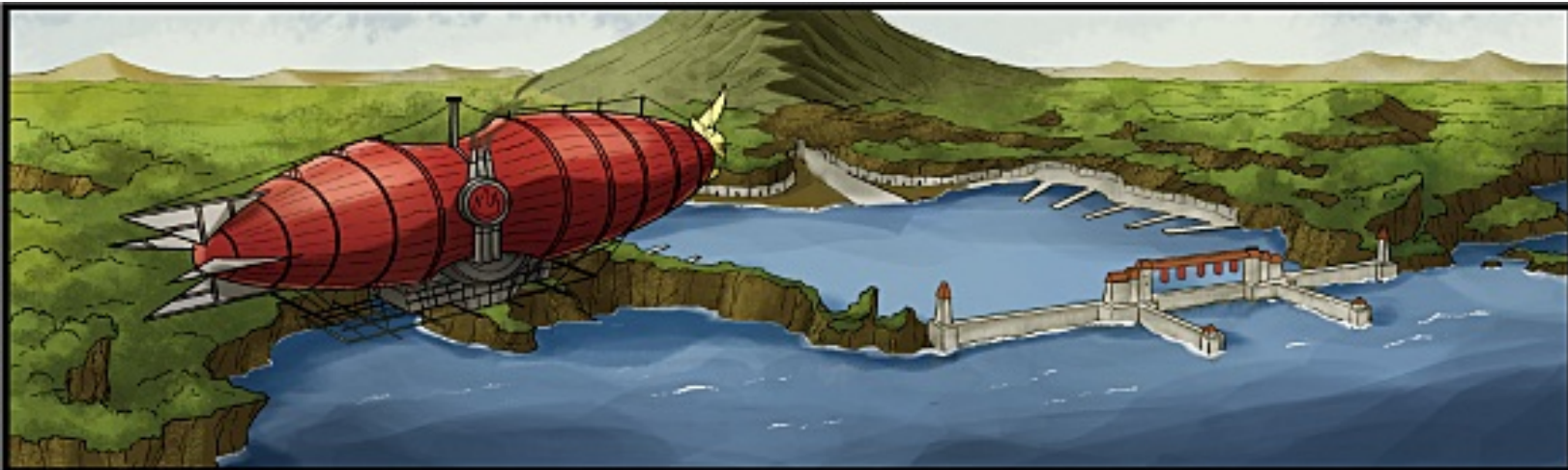
JUST TRYING TO KEEP YOU SAFE, MA'AM.





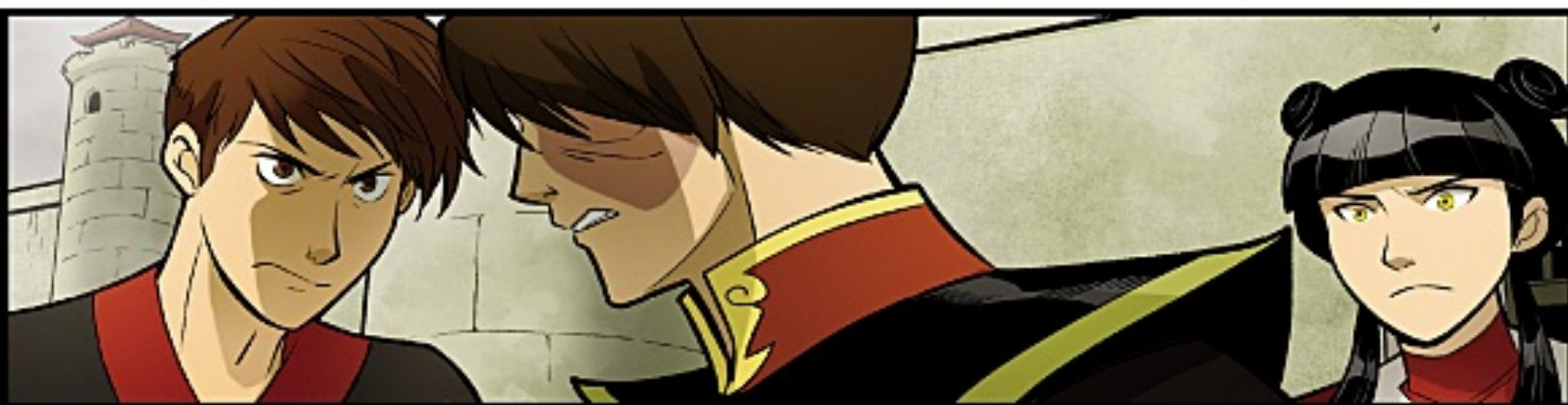
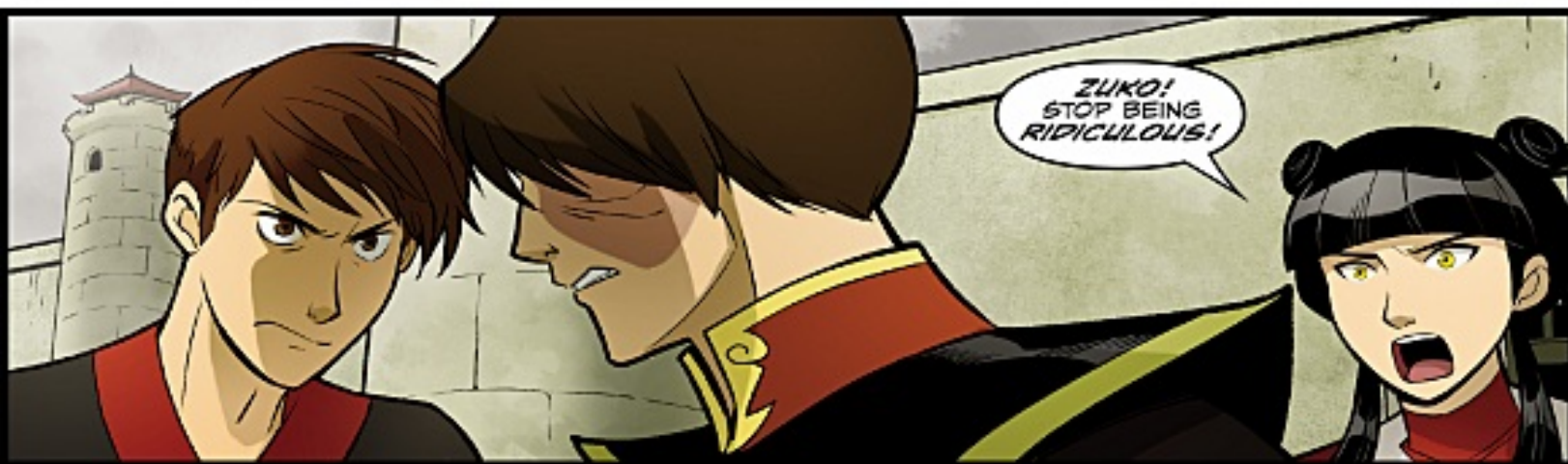












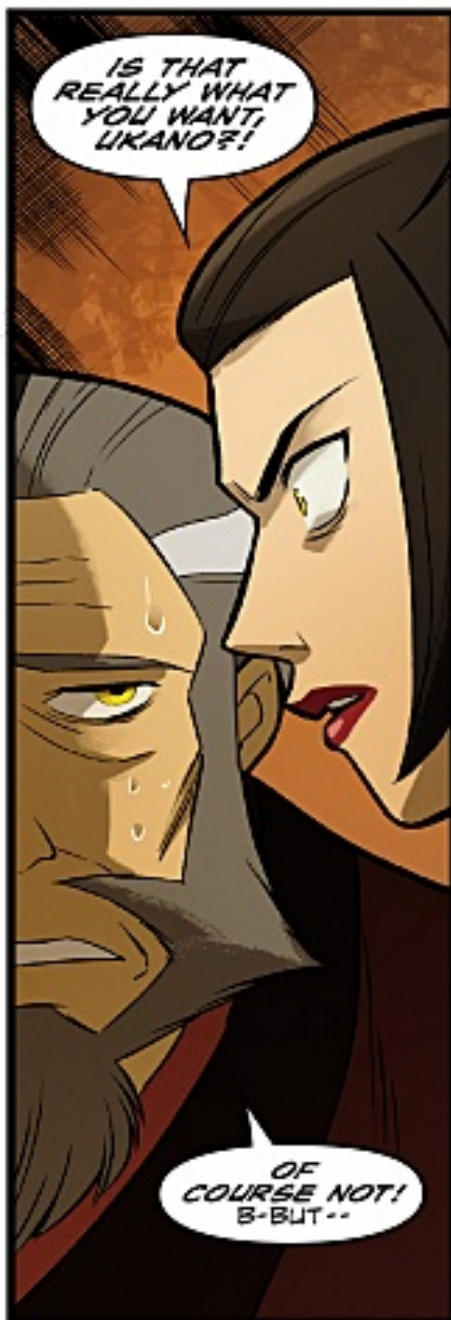














COME
PLAY, TOM-
TOM.

BUT
THERE WAS
THAT *CLICKING*
NOISE. MY DAD
ALWAYS COMES
IN AFTER THAT
CLICKING NOISE.



HOW
COME TOM-
TOM'S DAD VISITS
HIM? WHAT ABOUT
OUR MOMS AND
DADS?

TOM-
TOM'S DAD IS
HERE 'CAUSE HE'S
A *BAD GUY*, JUST
LIKE THE *SCARY*
LADIES.



THAT'S
NOT TRUE!
YOU TAKE
THAT BACK!

MAKE
ME!



WILL YOU
BOYS BE *QUIET*?!
I'M TRYING TO
CONCENTRATE
HERE!

WHAT'RE
YOU DOING,
KIYI?



PRACTICING.

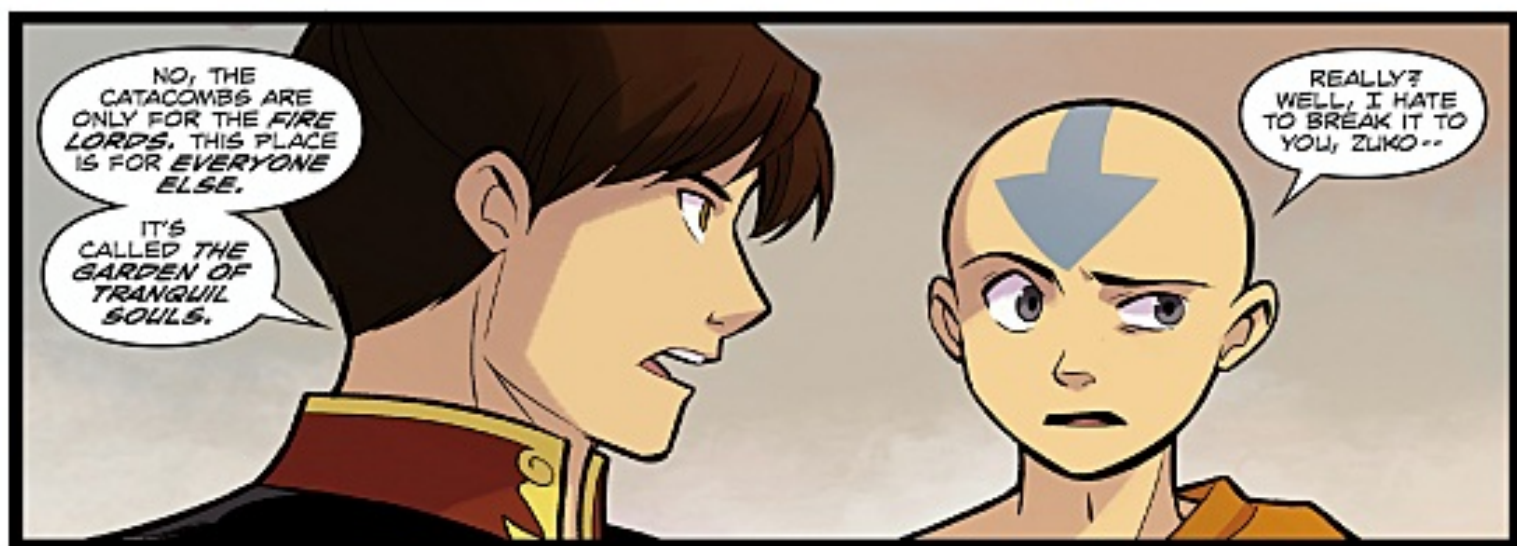
PRACTICING
WHAT?

I'M NOT
SURE... BUT THIS
ONE TIME, WHEN
ZUKO DIDN'T KNOW
I WAS LOOKING,
I WATCHED HIM
DO THIS IN THE
COURTYARD.

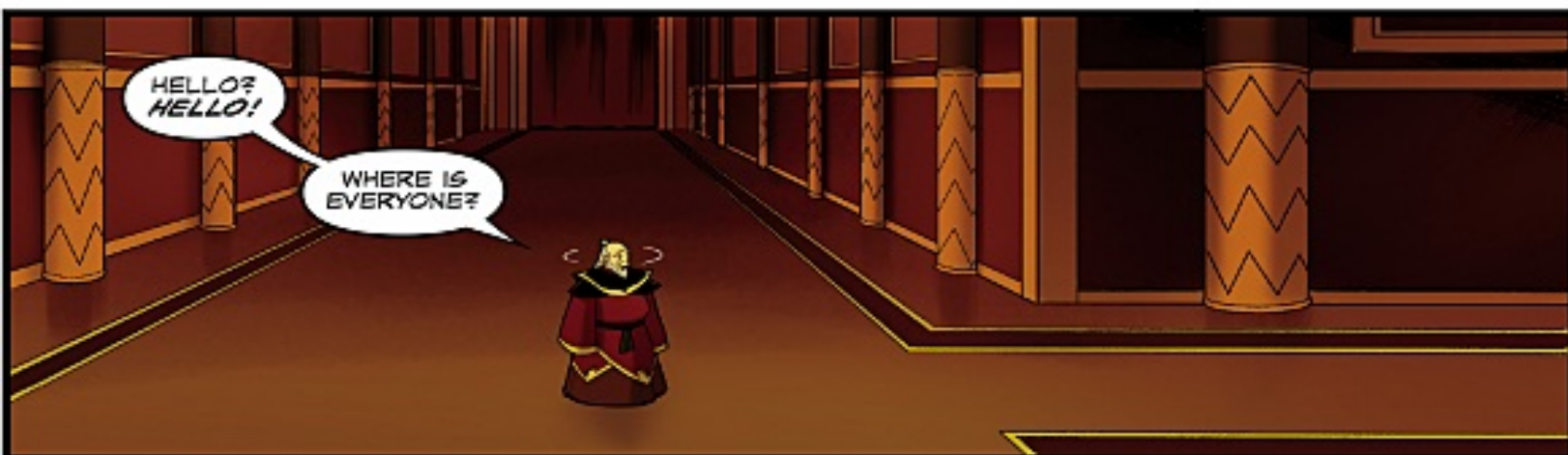
I THINK
IT'S WHAT
MAKES HIM *SO*
BRAVE.







-- BUT THE SOULS HERE DON'T SEEM ALL THAT TRANQUIL!





ALL I
WANTED WAS
FOR US TO BE
*SAFE, OUR FAMILY,
OUR NATION,
EVERYBODY,
SAFE.*



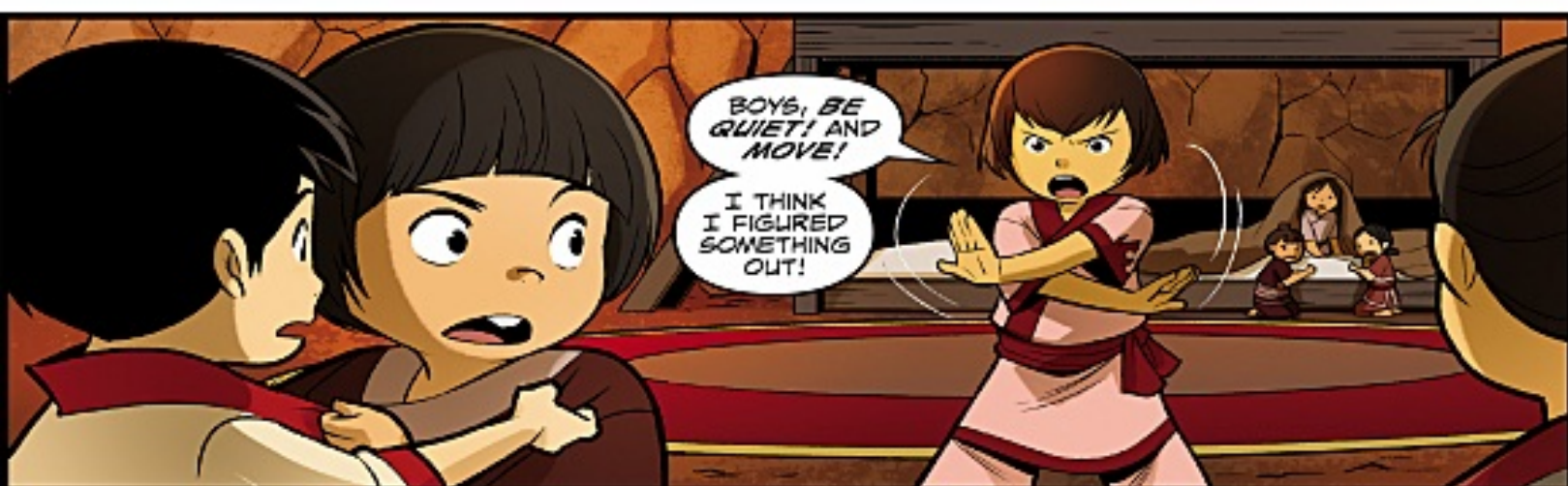
AND
IN MY ZEAL,
I DELIVERED YOU
INTO THE HANDS
OF A *MADWOMAN*,
TO BE LOCKED
AWAY IN A *DINGY
UNDERGROUND
PRISON!*



I'M
SORRY, TOM-
TOM. ALL OF YOU
IN THERE... *I'M
SORRY.*



THERE'S
NO PUNISHMENT
SEVERE ENOUGH
FOR THE LIKES
OF *ME.*







TOM-TOM!

DADDY!

MARRY ME!

NO THANKS.

HOORAY FOR KIIYI! HOORAY FOR KIIYI!

LISTEN, CHILDREN!
A TERRIBLE,
TERRIBLE CRIME
HAS BEEN COMMITTED
AGAINST YOU! THE
PERPETRATORS
MUST GO TO
PRISON...

...AND
THAT
INCLUDES
ME.

WHAT
DO YOU
MEAN,
DADDY?

BUT
BEFORE THAT,
WE NEED TO GET
YOU BACK TO YOUR
PARENTS!

YAY!

AND
BEFORE
THAT, YOU
MUST KEEP
YOUR VOICES
DOWN SO WE
WON'T GET
CAUGHT BY
THE SCARY
LADIES!

NOW
FOLLOW
ME!





NICE
THROW, MAI!
YOU'VE BEEN
PRACTICING!

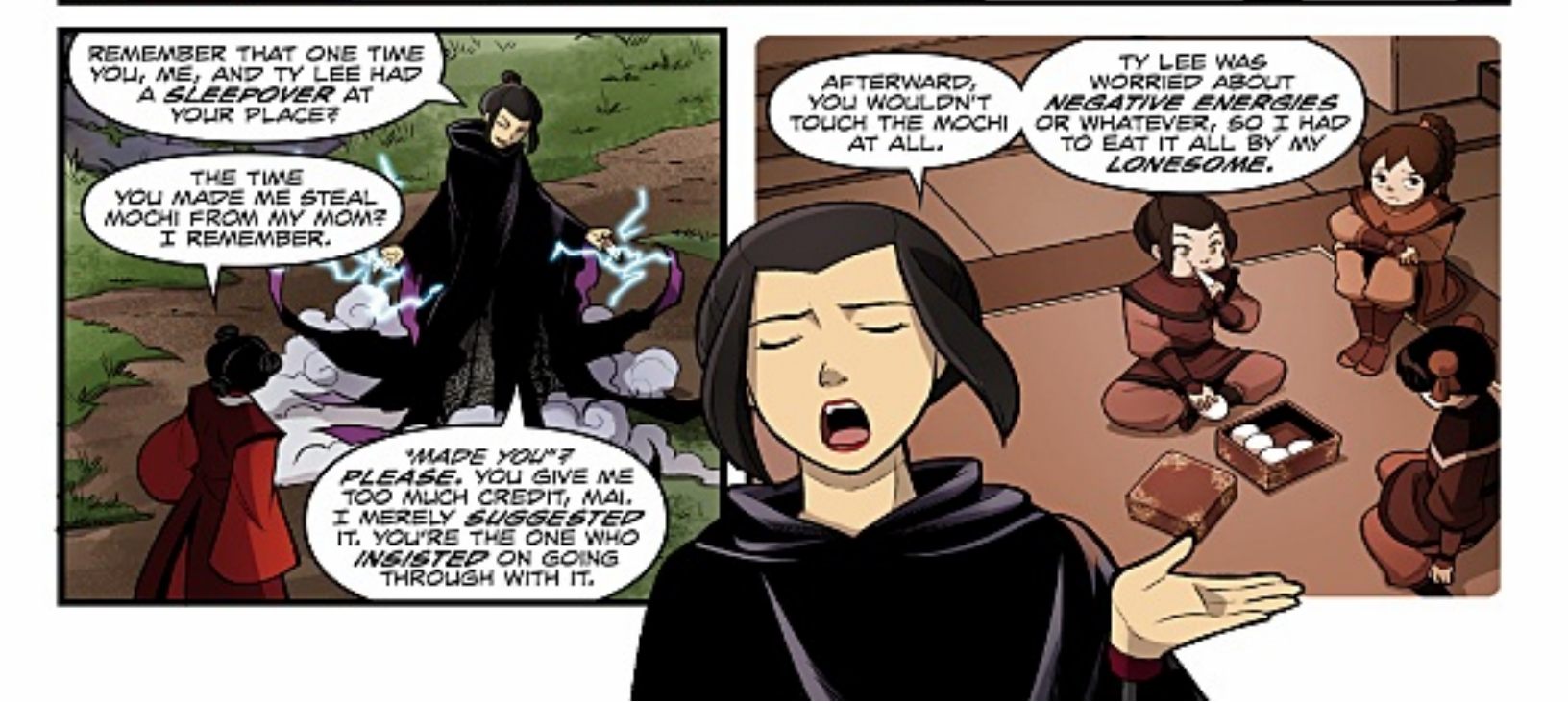
AZULA!
WHERE ARE YOU
HIDING THOSE
KIDS?!

SHING!



TSK TSK.
MANNERS, MANNERS! IS
THAT ANY WAY TO GREET
AN OLD FRIEND?

I REALLY
OUGHT TO
THANK YOU,
YOU KNOW!



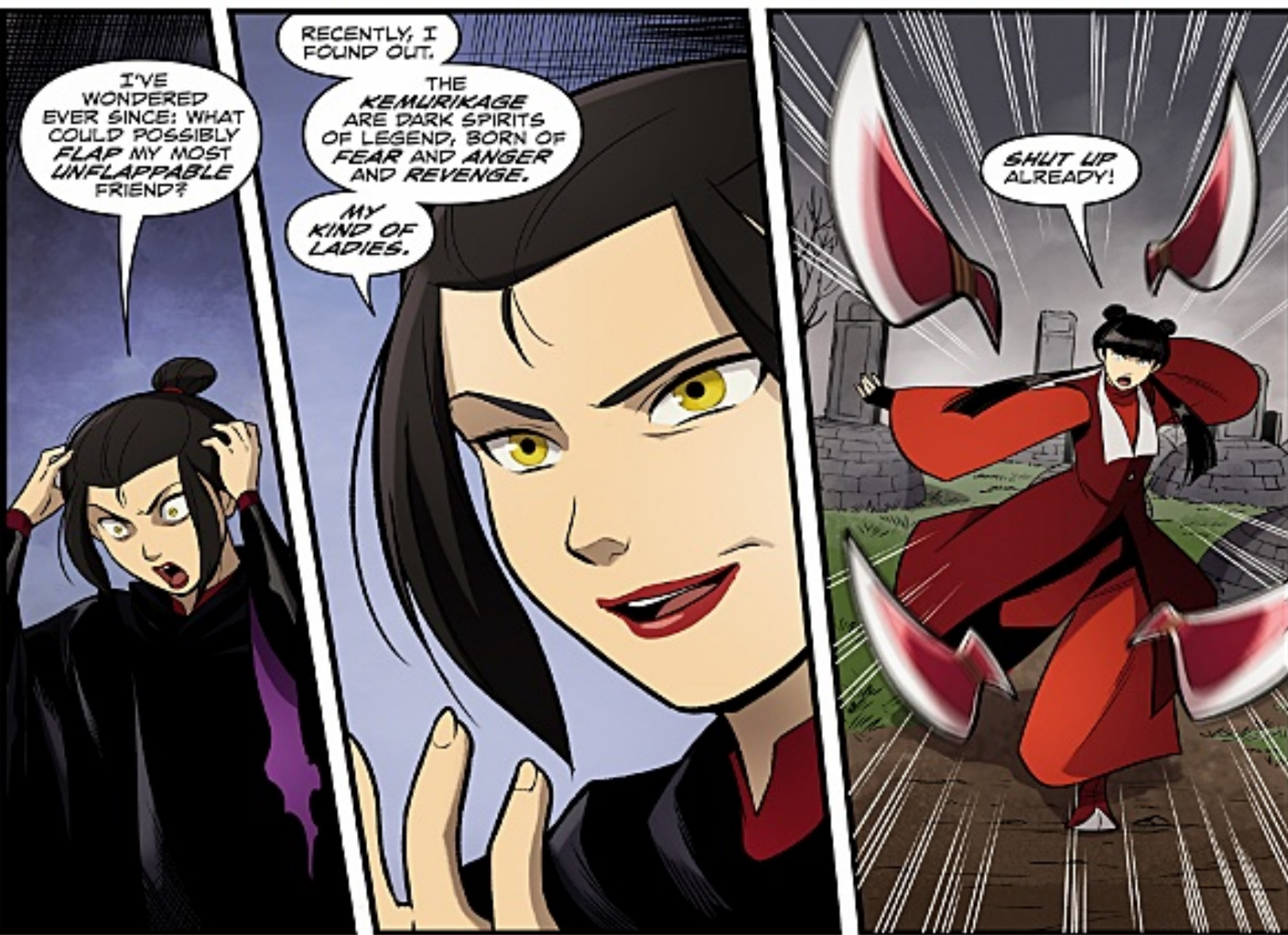
REMEMBER THAT ONE TIME
YOU, ME, AND TY LEE HAD
A SLEEPOVER AT
YOUR PLACE?

THE TIME
YOU MADE ME STEAL
MOCHI FROM MY MOM?
I REMEMBER.

'MADE YOU'?
PLEASE. YOU GIVE ME
TOO MUCH CREDIT, MAI.
I MERELY SUGGESTED
IT. YOU'RE THE ONE WHO
INSISTED ON GOING
THROUGH WITH IT.

AFTERWARD,
YOU WOULDN'T
TOUCH THE MOCHI
AT ALL.

TY LEE WAS
WORRIED ABOUT
NEGATIVE ENERGIES
OR WHATEVER, SO I HAD
TO EAT IT ALL BY MY
LONESOME.





MY NEW FRIENDS AND I TOOK OUR *INSPIRATION* FROM YOUR LITTLE NIGHTMARE. WHAT DO YOU THINK?

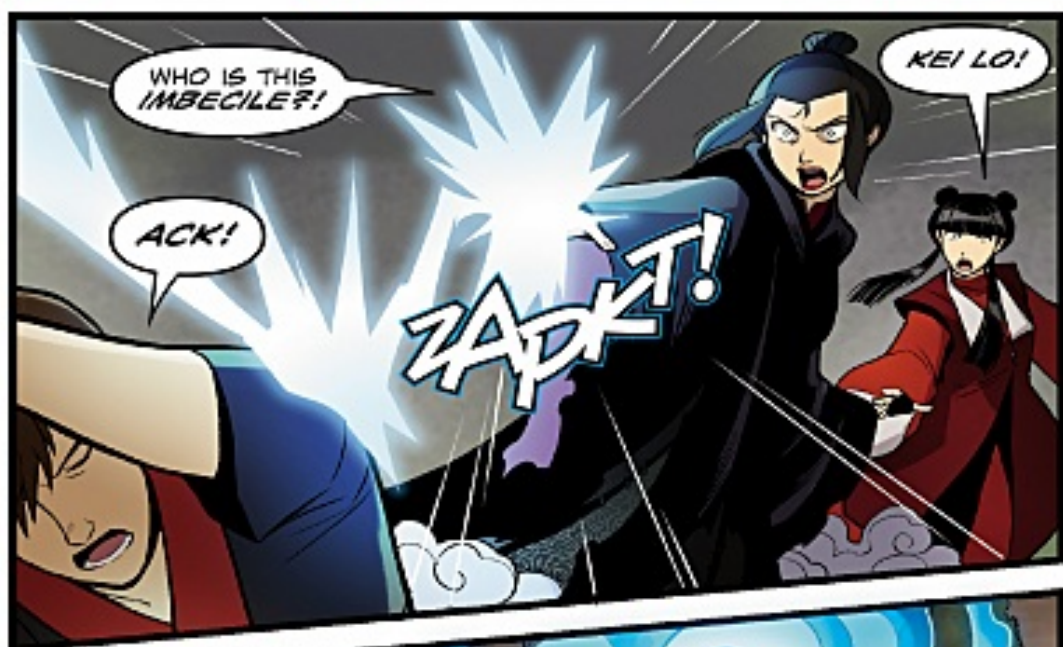
NOT A BAD RENDITION, HM?



EH.



PURPLE ISN'T REALLY YOUR COLOR, AZULA.



WHO IS THIS IMBECILE?!

ACK!

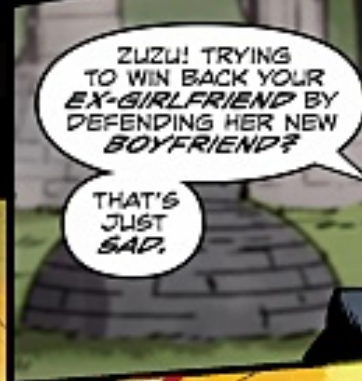
KEI LO!



PLEASE TELL ME THIS ISN'T YOUR NEW BOYFRIEND, MAI!

ZUZU WASN'T ALL THAT GREAT A CATCH, BUT, DEAR, YOU'RE REALLY SLUMMING IT!

AZULA, PLEASE! LEAVE HIM ALONE!









I MADE THIS DOLL WITH MY OWN HANDS. YOU CAN TELL FROM THE TERRIBLE STITCHING. IT WAS HER BIRTHDAY PRESENT LAST YEAR.

KIYI CARRIED IT WITH HER EVERYWHERE SHE WENT...

...UNTIL THE NIGHT MY FACE CHANGED BACK.

NOW SHE WON'T TOUCH IT. NOW SHE WON'T TOUCH ME.

WHAT IF THIS IS HOW IT WILL ALWAYS BE FROM NOW ON? WHAT IF I NEVER GET THE CHANCE TO --

WE HAVE NO REASON TO LOSE HOPE, URSULA.



CAN I ASK YOU SOMETHING, IROH? SOMETHING TERRIBLY PERSONAL?

OF COURSE. ANYTHING.



HOW DID YOU GET OVER THE DEATH OF YOUR SON?



I'M *NOT* OVER IT. I WILL *NEVER* BE OVER IT.

AS PARENTS, WE WANT NOTHING MORE THAN FOR OUR CHILDREN TO BE *SAFE*.

UNFORTUNATELY, THIS WORLD IS AN INHERENTLY *UNSAFE* PLACE, SO MANY *DANGERS*, SO MUCH TO *FEAR*.

NO MATTER HOW HARD WE TRY, WE CAN NEVER KEEP OUR CHILDREN *COMPLETELY* *SAFE*.



BETTER TO TEACH THEM-- AND OURSELVES -- TO SEE THE FEAR WITH *UNCLOUDED* EYES.

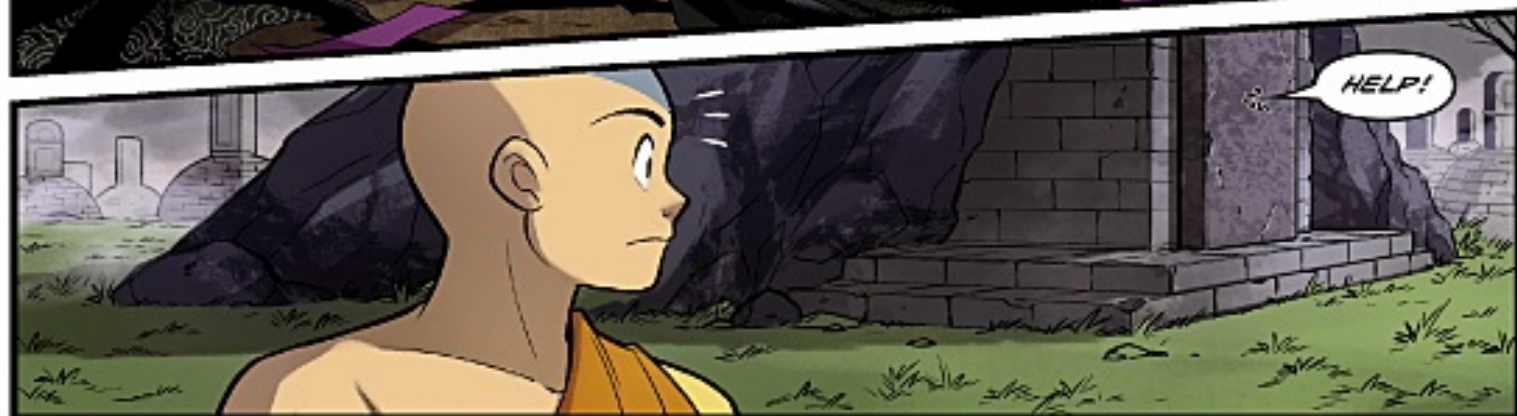
I TRY TO STAY *POSITIVE*. HONESTLY, I TRY... BUT IT'S ALL JUST A *MASK*. DEEP DOWN, ALL I FEEL IS *FEAR*.



URSA, THE *FEAR* WILL ALWAYS BE WITH YOU. *ALWAYS*, EVEN AFTER SHE RETURNS.

YOU MUST LEARN TO SEE IT WITH *UNCLOUDED* EYES.









WAIT,
AZULA! I
JUST WANT
TO TALK!



AZULA...?



SLAM!

!



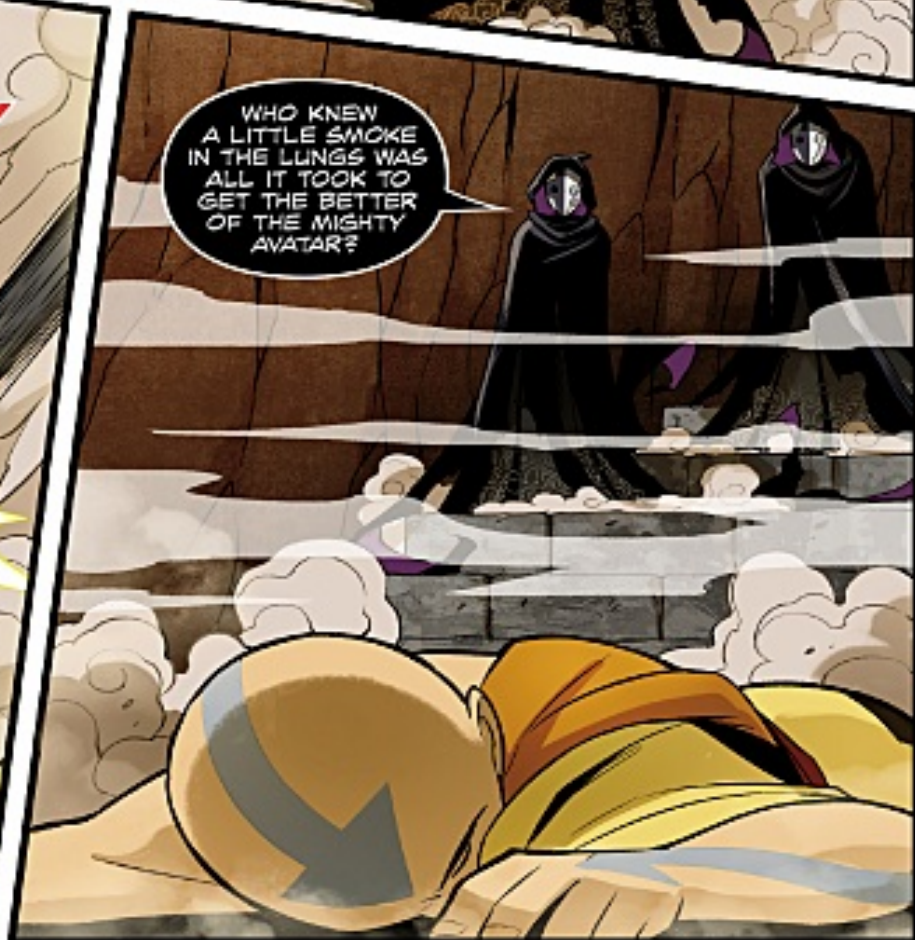
HELLO, DEAR
BROTHER. ANY IDEA
WHOSE CRYPT
WE'RE IN?

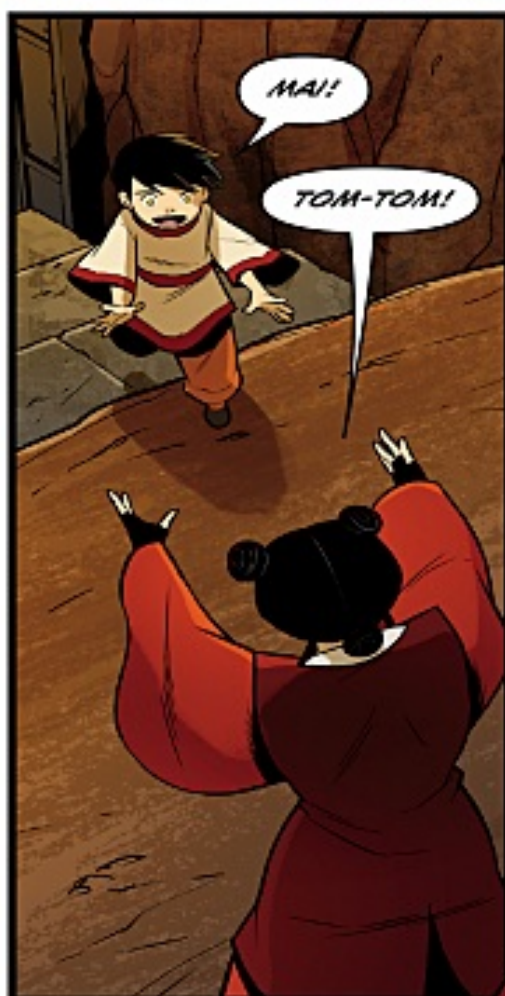
NO.

IT BELONGS
TO THE FIRST
LORD'S MOST
TRUSTED ADVISER.
RATHER FANCY,
ISN'T IT?

LISTEN,
AZULA--













ACCEPT IT?

I'VE
EMBRACED
IT!



I
KNOW I WILL
NEVER BE FIRE
LORD BECAUSE
I'M NOT *MEANT*
TO BE FIRE
LORD!

YOU
WERE *RIGHT*
ALL ALONG,
ZUZU! ONCE I
DISCOVERED MY
OWN *DESTINY*,
THAT VOICE IN MY
HEAD FINALLY
SHUT UP!



I'VE FELT
WEIGHTLESS
EVER SINCE...*FREE*.
MAYBE FOR THE
FIRST TIME IN ALL
MY LIFE.

THAT'S,
UH... THAT'S
GREAT, AZULA...
I GUESS...



MY
DESTINY,
YOU SEE, IS TO
MAKE *YOU* INTO THE
FIRE LORD I TRIED
TO BE -- ONE WHO'S
STRONG, WHO
RULES THROUGH
FEAR!



IN THE LAST
TWENTY-FOUR
HOURS, I'VE
SHOWN JUST HOW
RUTHLESS YOU
CAN BE.

DEEP DOWN
INSIDE, YOU'RE STILL
ONE OF US. YOU CAN
DENY IT FOR A LITTLE
WHILE, BUT EVENTUALLY,
YOU WILL BECOME *JUST
LIKE ME*...

...AND
THEN, IN A
SENSE, I'LL BE
FIRE LORD
AGAIN.

NO!
YOU'RE
WRONG!

TAKE YOUR OWN
ADVICE, ZUZU, AND
ACCEPT IT.

IT'S
WHO YOU
ARE.

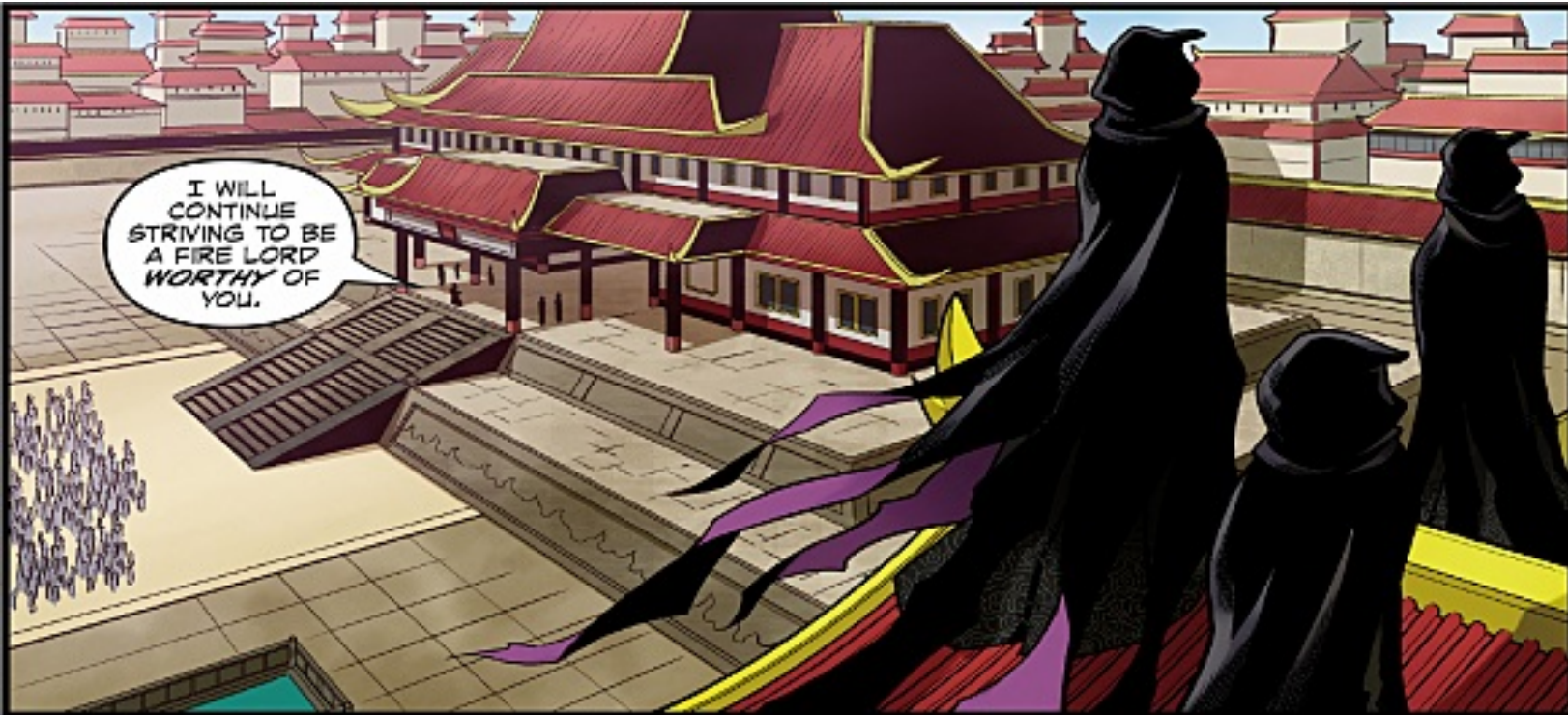
















I PROMISED YOU THAT IF I EVER SAW YOU AGAIN, I WOULD END YOU AND EVERYONE YOU'VE EVER LOVED!

BUT I'M GOING TO DO SO MUCH MORE THAN THAT. BY THE TIME I'M THROUGH, YOU WILL BEG FOR OBLIVION!

YOU HEAR ME, YOU WRETCHED THING?!

YOU WILL BEG!



YOU.
I SEE YOU.

AFTER ALL THESE YEARS, I FINALLY SEE YOU, OZAI.

YOU'RE JUST A SMALL, SMALL MAN TRYING WITH ALL YOUR MIGHT TO BE BIG.

YOUR HEART IS SO SMALL, YOU'VE NO ROOM FOR YOUR SON, OR YOUR DAUGHTER, OR YOUR BROTHER...

...OR EVEN YOURSELF.

GOODBYE, OZAI.

B-B-BUT--!

D-DON'T YOU TURN YOUR BACK ON ME! COME BACK AND GROVEL BEFORE ME!

DO YOU HEAR ME?!

COME BACK AND GROVEL!





COMING IN OCTOBER 2016

Katara and Sokka return to the Southern Water Tribe in . . .

NORTH AND SOUTH • PART ONE



The identity of the Kemurikage revealed!

When Azula is discovered to be the ringleader of the shadowy Kemurikage, Aang and Zuko will stop at nothing to chase her down and rescue the children—even if it means turning on each other! As Zuko locks down the capital to find her, riots erupt in the streets and the citizens are on edge. An unexpected clue from Mai and Ty Lee will help Team Avatar uncover Azula's plot, which is more sinister than they could have imagined. Will they stop her in time?

Writer Gene Luen Yang and artists Gurihiru, the team behind bestsellers *The Promise*, *The Search*, and *The Rift*, are back again! Developed in close collaboration with *Avatar: The Last Airbender* and *The Legend of Korra* creators Michael Dante DiMartino and Bryan Konietzko, this is the definitive continuation of the beloved TV series!



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GRAPHIC NOVEL/MEDIA TIE-IN

SON OF ULTRON

"THIS FAN...
THIS MONSTER!"

